Ancient Egypt

Located in Africa, Ancient Egypt has long fascinated and intrigued the world. As one of the earliest civilizations, it boasts a rich history and mesmerizing culture, which continues to inspire historians and artists today.

While the country is known as Egypt, the name was actually derived from the Greeks. The original name was *Aegyptos*, which in turn was known as Hwt-Ka-Ptah, meaning the House of the Spirit of Ptah. Ptah is one of the earliest deities to be worshipped in the region. During the Old Kingdom period, the country was named Kemet, which translates as the 'Black Land'. This term refers to the plentiful, black soil found on the banks of the River Nile that was home to the earliest settlements. In time, it was then renamed Misr (meaning *country*) and is still used by Egyptians today.

Between 8,000 to 525 BCE, Egypt was independent from any other civilization and renowned for its iconic architecture, artwork and sciences. Various monuments and structures still survive from this period, including those that tourists visit Egypt to see for themselves.

Archaeologists have discovered that in parts of the Sahara Desert, there is evidence to suggest that cattle were fed here around the ninth and eighth centuries BCE. Along with other artifacts, the evidence points to a flourishing civilization that grew with agriculture. Since the soil was dry at this point, the hunter-gatherers settled near the life-giving waters of the River Nile sometime before 6,000 BCE. Systemized farming began around a thousand years later, with the Badarian Culture emerging around 5,500 BCE. Other cultures which followed the Badarian include the Amratian (Nagada I), the Gerzean (Nagada II) and the Nagada Cultures (Nagada III).

Each of these cultures laid down the foundations for the future Egyptian civilization. Written records of history began to be documented sometime between 3,400 and 3,200 BCE with the introduction of the Hieroglyphics Scripts that were established by the Nagada III culture. Mummification started at Hierakonpolis when imposing stone tombs were erected at Abydos. The Palermo Stone, dated to around 3,000 BCE, indicates that